



Mentor mode: Kevin Pietersen is relishing his role in shaping Delhi Capitals' players into smarter, sharper cricketers. SPORTZPICS/IPL

straighter line. If the youngster evolves into a more destructive batter in the months ahead, that caption might prove prophetic.

Vivek Krishnan

Royal return

The last time Jackson Warne (**below**) visited Jaipur was 14 years ago, when he shared fond memories of the city's tradition and culture with his father — the late Shane Warne.

As he walked around the Sawai Mansingh Stadium now and watched a few matches from the Shane Warne Gallery, a special enclosure dedicated to his father, who was also Rajasthan Royals' first captain, nostalgia set in. The young Warne recalled the good old days. "I would have been 11 years old the last time I was here, so it's special to be back. It was also cool to see that the tickets had his name on them — they read 'Shane Warne Gallery,'" Jackson said.

During his visit, Jackson had extended conversations with Royals' head coach Rahul Dravid,

director of cricket Kumar Sangakkara, and several players.

Wearing Rajasthan Royals colours, he cheered for the team and made an effort to connect with some of the cricketers.

Shayan Acharya

Ahead of CSK's IPL 2025 match against Sunrisers Hyderabad, this Diary was one such scavenger, performing the exercise more out of professional obligation. The Diary isn't deranged enough to find excitement from trotting around in Chennai's sweltering heat, while running the potential risk of being rejected by random strangers.

And thus, the Diary was on its way, swallowing its inner apprehensions and plastering a fake smile on its face, asking melancholic CSK fans, "Would you rather have RCB or MI win the IPL title?" Ughh.

Pranay Rajiv

'A mentor like KP is all you need'

According to Kevin Pietersen, mentor of Delhi Capitals in this year's Indian Premier League (IPL), a two-month stint in franchise cricket is not enough time for a coach — no matter how highly rated — to make a meaningful impact on a player. However, Pietersen believes the work he is doing with Abishek Porel,

a talented left-handed batter and wicketkeeper from Bengal, will benefit the 22-year-old in the medium to long term.

"I've been working on something with Porel," Pietersen said at a press conference in Delhi. "I told Abi: 'This won't work for you tomorrow. It might not even work next week. But if you keep at it over the next month, two months, three months, four months, I promise it'll help you become a more destructive batter.' The key is to lay the foundations now."

A video clip posted by Delhi Capitals on Instagram — captioned "a mentor like KP is all you need" — suggests the England great has been focusing on getting Porel to swing the bat in a

RAJASTHAN ROYALS

